of the garment on the wearer. Therefore all main parts of the garments are cut in lengthwise grain. Crosswise grain gives more elasticity. Small parts of the garments like collars, pockets, and yokes can be cut on cross grain.

11.3 SHRINKAGE

Shrinkage is described as the reduction in length and width of the cloth when washed. If a garment shrinks, it will ruin the fit. Therefore all fabric should be subjected to shrinking before cutting and sewing. Shrinkage can be carried out in different methods. They also vary from fabric to fabric.

11.3.1 Shrinkage of Fabric without Water

The fabric should be placed on the table with face side lying down for the shrinkage. A wet cloth or towel should be kept between the two fabrics and iron with warm heat. While ironing, the wet cloth that is present in between will give air due to heat and help in the shrinking of the fabrics. Then ironing must be done in all places.

For woolen fabric the wet cloth must be kept in between the fabrics for one night. After that the cloth that was kept above the wool fabric should be removed. The woolen fabric should be spread on the wrong side facing upward. Ironing should be done by keeping the fabric above the wool fabric and it should be left to dry naturally. This process should be done two times.

11.3.2 Shrinkage of Fabric with Water

The fabric to shrink should be kept in the soap solutions for four hours. In case of cotton fabric hot water is needed. The fabric should be stirred from time to time. After that, it should be rinsed for 3-4 times and dried by hanging in the lengthwise direction. While drying the cloth avoid using steel rods and use thread ropes. Ironing must be done while the fabric is slightly wet. In case of coloured cloth they must be soaked separately and washed.

DO YOU KNOW?

Can you identify the fabric by seeing and feeling?

Cotton fabrics are normally stiff. It will get crushed easily and the crease is left on the fabric.

Silk fabrics are very smooth to touch, bright and lustrous to see. The fingers run softly over silk fabrics.

Woolen fabrics are coarse to touch, with small protruding fiber hairs.

Polyester and rayon fabrics are smooth to touch and lustrous to see. These fabrics do not get crushed easily.

Twill fabrics show a diagonal effect and are course to feel.

Napped fabrics (pile and velvet) have loops or short hairy structure. It is smooth to touch.

11.4 FABRIC STRAIGHTENING

Fabric undergoes tension, while weaving, knitting, dyeing or printing. During these processes the position of the yarns can change resulting inbalance of the fabric. If a garment is cut and stitched when the yarns are not straight, then the drape of the garment will not be correct. Therefore it is important to ensure the correct placement of the yarn before cutting. This process of placing the misplaced yarns in the correct

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